

GUIDELINE DOCUMENT — FOR ADOPTION

PROJECT BUILD GUIDELINE

DOCUMENT NO. GMN-PG-001	VERSION 1.0 — Draft for adoption	DATE 04 July 2026
APPLIES TO All Halls of Worship and ancillary buildings in Nigeria	STATUS Mandatory once adopted	PREPARED BY Vollmann Akarakiri

01. PURPOSE

This guideline defines **how every Grail Message Foundation building project in Nigeria is initiated, planned, designed, built and handed over**. Its objectives are:

- 01

Cost-effectiveness — no project starts without a realistic budget, and no money is spent outside approved procedures.
- 02

Consistent standards — every hall meets the same quality benchmark regardless of location.
- 03

Proper supervision and control — clear roles, clear reporting, and a documented trail for every decision.

04 Reusability — designs, models and documents from one project accelerate the next.

No project may proceed to a new phase without completing the **gate approval** of the previous phase (Section 04).

02. SCOPE

This guideline applies to new Halls of Worship; extensions, renovations and major repairs of existing halls; and ancillary buildings (administration, accommodation, utilities) on hall sites. Minor maintenance below the threshold set by the Project Board is exempt but must still be recorded in the site logbook.

03. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Every project must have the following roles filled **in writing** before Phase 1 is approved. One person may hold more than one role only where expressly permitted below.

Role	Responsibility	Notes
Project Board	Approves budget, phase gates, and changes above the change threshold. Owns the project.	Minimum 3 members. Represents Foundation leadership.
Project Manager (PM)	Day-to-day management: programme, budget tracking, coordination, reporting to the Board.	Must not also be the Contractor.
Design Lead / Architect	Design, drawings and BIM model per GMN-BIM-001.	ARCON-registered where the law requires.
Structural / MEP Engineers	Engineering design and construction-stage checks.	COREN-registered where the law requires.
Quantity Surveyor (QS)	Bill of quantities, cost plan, valuations, cost reporting per GMN-CM-001.	Independent from the Contractor.
Site Supervisor / Clerk of Works	Daily site presence, inspections and reports per GMN-QS-001.	Reports to the PM, not to the Contractor.

Contractor(s)	Execution of the works under contract.	Selected per the procurement rules in GMN-CM-001.
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KEY CONTROL: the person who approves payment must never be the same person who certifies the work, and neither may be the Contractor. This three-way separation (certify → recommend → approve) is mandatory.

04. PROJECT PHASES AND GATE APPROVALS

Every project passes through six phases. Each phase ends with a **gate**: a documented approval by the Project Board. Skipping a gate is a breach of this guideline.

PHASE 0 — INITIATION

- Need identified (new hall, extension, repair). **Deliverable:** Project Charter (template GMN-T-01) — purpose, location, rough capacity, order-of-magnitude cost, funding source, proposed team.
- **Gate 0:** Board approves the Charter and releases feasibility funds only.

PHASE 1 — FEASIBILITY & LAND

- Confirm land title/documents (C of O, deed, survey plan) and site suitability (soil investigation, access, utilities, flooding, topographic survey).
- Preliminary capacity brief: congregation size, growth allowance, ancillary needs. Budget estimate (Class D, ±30%) prepared by the QS.
- **Gate 1:** Board approves site, brief and budget envelope.

PHASE 2 — DESIGN

- Concept design → developed design → technical design, each reviewed against the brief and the cost plan. Full BIM model produced per GMN-BIM-001; drawings are extracted from the model, never drawn separately.
- Statutory approvals obtained: state development permit / building approval, environmental requirements, fire service where applicable.
- QS updates the cost plan at each design stage; if the estimate exceeds the envelope, the design is **re-worked — the budget is not silently increased**.
- **Gate 2:** Board approves final design, cost plan (Class B, ±10%), and authority approvals in hand.

PHASE 3 — PROCUREMENT

- Bill of Quantities produced from the BIM model. Contractor selection by competitive tender per GMN-CM-001 — minimum three bids for works above the tender threshold.
- Contract signed **before** any mobilisation payment; the contract defines scope, price, programme, retention, defects liability period and variation procedure.
- **Gate 3:** Board approves contract award and full construction budget.

PHASE 4 — CONSTRUCTION

- Works executed under continuous supervision per GMN-QS-001. Monthly: valuation by QS, progress report by PM to the Board, updated cost forecast.
- All changes go through the **change order procedure** — no verbal instructions to the Contractor carry cost or scope effect.
- **Gate 4:** Practical completion certified — snag list issued, hall usable.

PHASE 5 — HANDOVER & CLOSE-OUT

- Defects liability period (minimum 6 months) with retention held. As-built BIM model and documents delivered and archived. Final account agreed and closed by the QS.
- **Lessons-learned report** written by the PM and filed — this is how the guideline itself improves.
- **Gate 5:** Board closes the project and releases final retention.

05. REPORTING AND CONTROL RHYTHM

Report	By	To	Frequency
Site diary	Site Supervisor	PM	Daily
Site progress report (GMN-T-02)	Site Supervisor	PM	Weekly
Cost report & forecast	QS	PM & Board	Monthly
Project status report	PM	Board	Monthly
Gate submission	PM	Board	At each gate

A project is **in exception** (Board must be notified within 7 days) if the forecast final cost exceeds the approved budget by more than 5%, the programme slips more than 4 weeks, or a safety incident, structural concern or statutory stop-order occurs.

06. DOCUMENTATION RULES

1. Every project gets a project code: **GMN-<STATE>-<TOWN>-<NN>** (e.g. **GMN-EN-ENUGU-01**) — used on all files, drawings and correspondence.
2. All project documents are filed in the standard folder structure defined in GMN-BIM-001 §7.
3. Decisions of the Board are minuted; instructions to contractors are written (site instruction forms); payments reference certificates.
4. As-built records are a condition of final payment to the Contractor.

07. COMPLIANCE WITH NIGERIAN LAW AND STANDARDS

- The **National Building Code** and the building/planning regulations of the state where the site is located (development permit before construction).
- Professional registration laws: **ARCON** (architects), **COREN** (engineers), **QSRBN** (quantity surveyors) for roles the law reserves.
- **Standards Organisation of Nigeria (SON)** standards for materials (cement, reinforcement, blocks, roofing) — material certificates are checked under GMN-QS-001.
- Labour, safety and insurance requirements, including contractor's all-risk insurance and workmen's compensation before site possession.

08. REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Change	Author
1.0	04 July 2026	First issue for adoption	Vollmann Akarakiri

AUTHORISATION

PREPARED BY

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